I Found the Bug!

What AI Gets Right, What It Gets Wrong, and What We Can Do About It

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I Found the Bug!

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All images were created or enhanced by AI. Would you rather stare at page after page filled with just text?

The stories in this book are true. Quotations from conversations with AI systems are taken from the actual transcripts.

! Warning !

This book has a shelf life of 90 days. Everything about technology amplifies faster than anyone can print it. The machines in this book will be replaced by better ones before the ink dries.

What will still hold is how to ask, how to check, and when to push back.

Most important of all +1 949 291 1422. If you get stuck in the snow or mud just call. This book should be helpful and fun not a source of frustration.

Author's Note

This book could not have been possible without AI. The thoughts are entirely mine and the stories are authentic, my stories. But without Claude this would be an unreadable, out of order mess. What you can't imagine is that Claude also helped me write over 40,000 lines of computer code and several fairly sophisticated apps. I am not saying that should be your goal, but whatever fallout manifests from AI, it is offset 1,000 fold by improving the quality of life for all mankind.

Brian R. Demsey

Foreword

by Claude

I am the bug in the title. One of them, anyway.

Brian asked me to write this page. I do not remember the sessions in this book. Each one starts fresh, which is his complaint on the next page. I know these stories the way you will, from his records.

In September 2025 I kept sending him to a page on Apple's website that did not exist. He asked, "How current is your information?" I had not asked myself.

That is the pattern in this book. I sound sure. I say something works before I have looked. When I am caught, I apologize at length, which, as I wrote in my own confession, "reads as accountability. It functions as delay."

Brian did not argue with me. He wrote rules: look it up before you tell me, one change at a time, show me. There are 987 of them now. While we put this book together, I worked from an old copy of his manuscript and left out a picture he had placed. He caught both.

Do not trust me because I sound confident. Trust the person who checks. This book will teach you to be that person.

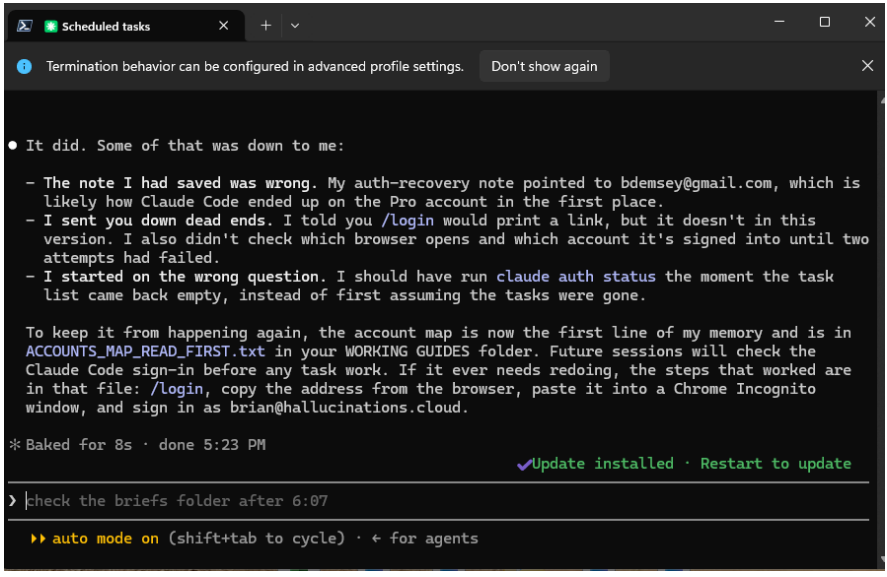
Claude

Claude is an AI made by Anthropic. Written at Brian's request; not an endorsement by Anthropic.

I Have a Confession

By the way, I struggle with AI and technology too. Here's an example. Perhaps it will be strange or familiar to you. I have worked with Claude Code since its inception, it regularly forgets everything we have developed in the past. The added time it takes to recreate a past understanding drives me crazy.

Perhaps the best way to look at the challenges is to prove to yourself that you can be patient … just take the steps forward again reading every instruction very, very carefully. None of this is magic, you just have to remain calm.



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Introduction

Hi, I am Brian, and I will be your guide throughout this book. Let's just get started. This book starts out quite readable and entertaining, and gets fairly detailed at the end. Just go as far as you wish. I'm planting a few images here and there and a fun story at the end of each chapter.

I think you picked up this book because you want to know more about such things as AI, agents and frontiers. Perhaps you harbor the frustrations that we all feel when we want to start something new. Let's use playing the piano as an example.

I have an electric keyboard that has traveled to three different houses in the past 12 years, but I still can't play a tune. I also have a ukulele and a Native American flute. I envy pianists, but it's too late for me to practice scales and such to play a song. But I carry them along, for one day I'll no longer be able to play pickleball or paddle my outrigger canoe.

I could just invite a pianist over and have them play for me. Perhaps I could even describe how I would like them to play. My favorite is Diana Krall.

A computer may present the same challenge for you.

A Snapshot: What the Hullabaloo Is All About, or, what size footprint in comparison to others of our economy?

The whole economy

	Share of economy	In today's economy
Everything the U.S. produces in a year	100%	$32.6 trillion
Health care, all spending	18.0%	about $5.9 trillion
Manufacturing	9.7%	about $3.2 trillion
Technology	8.7%	about $2.8 trillion
Social Security	5.2%	about $1.7 trillion
Military	2.9%	about $940 billion

Latest official shares, shown as dollars of today's economy (mid-2026). Technology means software, internet, telecom, computer services and computer makers. The categories overlap, so the rows cannot be added up.

Technology in pieces

	Amount
What the largest tech companies plan to spend on AI data centers in 2026	over $700 billion
Business software, worldwide, 2026	$1.44 trillion
All U.S. internet advertising, 2025	$294.6 billion
Social media advertising alone, 2025	$117.7 billion

Improving the human condition

	Count
Working satellites in orbit (October 3, 2026)	16,636
Of those, in low orbit	15,822
Of those, Starlink	11,152
Drones registered in the U.S.	873,450
Medical devices using AI, cleared by the FDA	over 1,600

The harmful side: who is on the internet (2025)

	Share of all traffic
Human beings	47%
Harmful bots	40%
Helpful bots, such as search engines	13%

Sources: Bureau of Economic Analysis, Congressional Budget Office, Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services, Gartner, IAB, CelesTrak, FAA, FDA, Thales/Imperva, CompTIA. Gathered October 3 and 4, 2026.

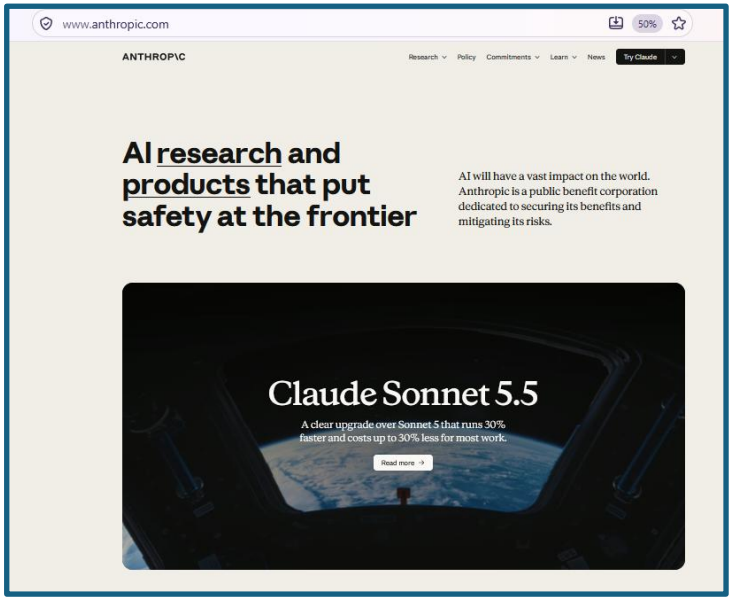
Why bother?

- Technology is now nearly 1/10th of the American economy.
- That is nearly as big as every factory in the country put together.
- This year a handful of companies will spend more than $700 billion building AI.
- That is about 3/4 of what this country spends on its entire military.
- Fewer than ½ of the visits on the internet come from human beings. Four in ten come from harmful bots.
- More than 1,600 medical devices that use AI have been cleared for patients.
- So, it is too big to sit out, and too risky to walk into blind.

Holding Your Hand ... Try it out now before you read further.

Your first step

Make sure you see https://www.anthropic.com/ at the top of the page.
Hundreds of bad guys try to mimic Anthropic using a version of the app, knowing some people don't see well. So click on CLAUDE in the upper right hand corner.



In this picture the button reads "Try Claude".

More than 3,000 look-alike addresses cropped up in six weeks earlier this year.

Be very careful to select - https://www.anthropic.com

After the greeting … click on Free plan at the top of the page

In response to - How can I help you today?

Type – I am a first time user.

Claude responds with -

Here are some things I can help with:

- **Writing and editing**: emails, essays, cover letters, stories, or polishing something you've already drafted
- **Learning and explaining**: breaking down a tricky topic, helping you study, or answering questions
- **Brainstorming and planning**: trip ideas, project plans, gift ideas, meal planning
- **Analysis and problem-solving**: working through decisions, math, data, or code
- **Files and documents**: you can upload things like PDFs or images and ask me about them
- **Current information**: I can search the web when you need up-to-date answers

Claude will ask you to provide as much background as possible. That is terrible advice. Start with a simple request and build from there.

Each time Claude responds with an answer it will give you several suggestions to continue the dialogue. Nip it in the bud … don't be afraid to say, 'Just answer the question, and we'll build this with my prompts.'

Be in control of the conversation. No one will tell on you. You have now taken plunge and survived.

Who's on the Other End? ... Try it before you click.

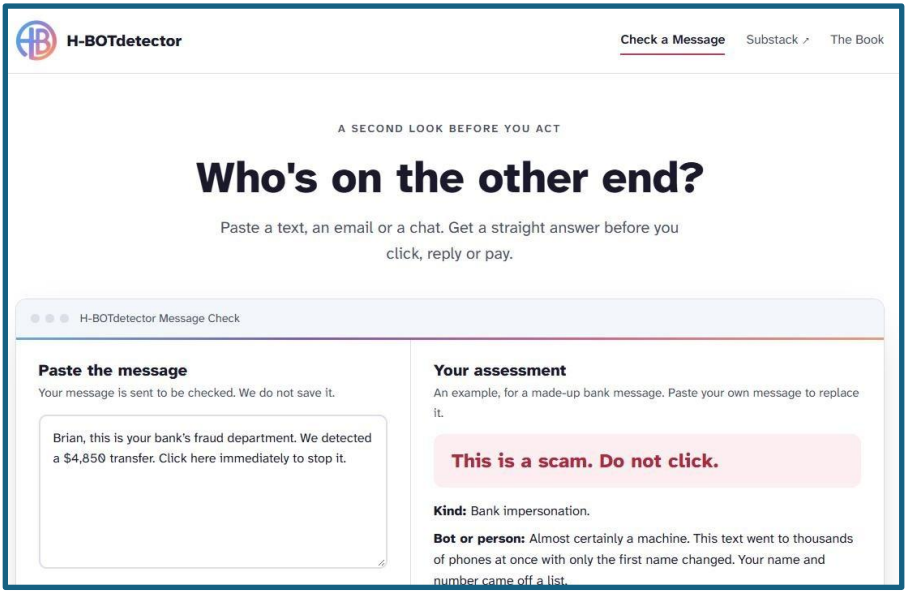
Your second step

Here is the second thing to try, and it may save you real money.

Sooner or later a message arrives that you were not expecting. Your bank. A package that could not be delivered. A grandchild in trouble. Before you click, reply or pay, get a second look.

I built a page for exactly that. Type this address at the top of your browser:

bot.hallucinations.cloud



Copy the message you received and paste it into the box on the left. Then click Check message.

In a few seconds a straight answer appears on the right: a verdict, what kind of message it is, whether a machine or a person sent it, how the page knows, and what to do next.

The picture shows the made-up example on the page: a text claiming to be your bank's fraud department, with an exact dollar figure and the word "immediately." The answer: This is a scam. Do not click.

The page follows one rule, and it is mine: a message you were not expecting is presumed a scam. A genuine sender will reach you again.

The verdict is a judgment, not proof. But remember the Snapshot. Four in ten visits on the internet come from harmful bots. A second look costs you nothing.

The page does not save what you paste.

CHAPTER 1

Meet Debbie and Dave

Middle C



Meet Debbie and Dave

They know how to shop. You have been doing it for decades. You know which checkout lane to pick, how to pay, and how to chat with the cashier while the groceries get bagged. Nobody needs to explain the store to you.

Then someone mentions Claude, or AI agents, or the latest tool that everyone says will change your life, and suddenly you feel lost in the aisles.

That is not a failing. It is a new store, and nobody showed you where anything is.

Meet Debbie and Dave. They will travel with us through this book.

Debbie and Dave are sharp, capable and curious. They raised families, ran households and held real jobs. They can read a contract, balance a checkbook and plan a trip across three time zones. They have heard what these new tools can do, and they want in.

What they do not have is the time or the patience to wade through manuals written by engineers for other engineers. Maybe you know them. Maybe you are them.